

Siphiwo Sizonqoba Manana

CRO and UI & UX Consultant | Conversion Rate Optimisation, Enterprise Product Design, Behavioural Analytics

Randburg, Johannesburg, South Africa | Available remote, UK and EU hours | Available immediately

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[LinkedIn](#) | [portfolio URL once live]

South African citizen | English, isiZulu, siSwati | Employed full-time by a UK company via Employer of Record since 2025

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

CRO and UX consultant with four years in UX and UI design and six in digital design, specialising in conversion for B2B SaaS, fintech and financial services. I own the full measurement loop rather than a slice of it: heuristic audit and scoring, GA4 and Google Tag Manager instrumentation, hypothesis design, A/B testing in VWO and Convert, then validation against a captured baseline sixty to ninety days later. I also design product surfaces, not only marketing sites: design lead on two shipped HubSpot UI extensions and on an internal CPQ platform that replaced spreadsheet-based service scoping. Delivery lead on engagements up to \$52,000, presenting audits and roadmaps directly to CEOs and Heads of Marketing. Three pieces of my work are published publicly by my employer, linked below.

SKILLS

Conversion rate optimisation: CRO strategy and roadmapping, heuristic audit and scoring, hypothesis design and prioritisation, A/B testing (VWO, Convert, GA4 experiments, HubSpot), funnel and drop-off analysis, landing page optimisation, baseline capture and post-implementation validation

Analytics and instrumentation: Google Analytics 4, Google Tag Manager (custom JavaScript variables, dataLayer, event and parameter design, trigger auditing), Microsoft Clarity (heatmaps, session recordings, funnels, segments), Looker Studio, HubSpot reporting, data validation and QA

Product and platform design: Enterprise UX, complex B2B workflow design, internal tool design, HubSpot CRM, HubSpot UI extensions and app cards, CPQ (Configure, Price, Quote), interaction design, design for React implementation, developer handoff and annotation

Design: Figma and FigJam, interactive prototyping, design systems and component libraries, information architecture, user flows, wireframing, high-fidelity UI, Adobe XD, Sketch, Adobe Creative Suite

Accessibility: WCAG 2.1 AA, contrast auditing at design stage and post-deployment QA, alt-text and asset naming standards, design-to-development regression checking

Front-end: HTML, CSS, WordPress and Elementor, UTM tracking implementation, form and API integration

Delivery: ClickUp process design and sprint management, AI-assisted templating and estimation, client workshops and presentations, roadmap and scope development

Certifications: Google Tag Manager Fundamentals (Analytics Mania, 2025), Google Analytics (Google Skillshop), HubSpot Reporting (HubSpot Academy), Inbound Marketing Optimization (HubSpot Academy), Master Figma: Web and Mobile App Design (Udemy)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

UX UI Consultant, Evara (formerly Inbound FinTech), London

June 2025 - September 2026 | Remote from South Africa | Employed via Remote.com (Employer of Record)

Conversion rate optimisation, UX and product design at an Elite HubSpot Solutions Partner for financial services, named Best Agency of the Year at the 2025 FinTech Marketing Global Awards. Client accounts: Dayshape, Employmate, Ruleguard, Redslim, Apella Wealth, Cambridge Commodities and BSO. Up to three concurrently.

Conversion rate optimisation and analytics

- Owned the full CRO measurement loop across client accounts: heuristic audit and scoring, baseline capture, design change and approval, GTM re-instrumentation and testing, sixty to ninety days of data collection, then validation against the baseline and against the success metrics hypothesised at the outset, reported through Looker Studio and narrative presentation.
- Designed and ran A/B tests in VWO and Convert on the BSO homepage, testing dual CTA placement at measured hesitation and scroll-depth points against variations in CTA weight, emphasis and copy, measured on bounce rate, page engagement and average engagement time.
- Raised form completion rate on a client demo funnel from roughly 33% to 75% (approximately 300 starts and 100 submissions, to 400 starts and 300 submissions) following form restructure and re-instrumentation.
- Diagnosed a compound tracking and media failure corrupting a client funnel: form-start events were firing on page view rather than user interaction, inflating starts. Traced the anomaly through GA4 into the client paid media platform, where geo-targeting had drifted outside their ICP as the system optimised for cheaper clicks, inflating traffic and recorded conversions alike.
- Built a custom Google Tag Manager JavaScript variable reading the data-step attribute on a multi-step demo form at the moment of click, distinguishing step-one from step-two continue events and enabling step-by-step funnel measurement where none previously existed.
- Developed a semi-automated behavioural metric framework scoring user behaviour on quantified signals including rage clicks, scroll depth and dead zones, reported to clients through Looker Studio.
- Built two internal tools now used by the delivery team: an audit scorer covering front-end and back-end conversion factors, and an unmoderated usability testing tool.
- Ran GTM audits on inherited accounts where triggers were missing or incorrectly implemented, rebuilt the tracking, then collected sixty to ninety days of clean data before writing any hypothesis, so recommendations rested on measurement rather than assumption.
- Achieved roughly 70 to 80% implementation of recommendations by pairing each to the client own data and to the behavioural mechanism behind it.

Product and platform design

- Designed the UI and UX of the Evara internal Configure, Price, Quote platform in Figma, replacing spreadsheet-based scoping with a structured workflow connected to HubSpot. Structured a six-pillar service catalogue into a usable information hierarchy, and designed service selection, parameter configuration, dynamic and module-level pricing, line-item generation and the multi-step quotation workflow including discounts, delivery timelines, payment terms and final review. Delivered to a two-day turnaround alongside live client projects. The design work was mine; the HubSpot integration, backend automation and pricing engine were not.
- Design lead on a custom CPQ quote cockpit for Cambridge Commodities, built as a HubSpot UI extension embedded in a CRM record page, pulling live cost and stock data from their Ross ERP and historical pricing from Snowflake. Worked with a project manager and a developer.
- Designed inside a hard platform constraint on that build: HubSpot UI extensions permit no custom CSS, so every decision had to be expressible in real components at real sizes. Derived a click-to-edit interaction pattern from the 240px minimum width of the input components against 774px of available space, and verified table overflow behaviour against HubSpot documentation rather than assuming it.
- Produced 43 frames covering the full quote lifecycle with failure states designed as first-class flows: partial ERP failure, order rejection, unreachable data warehouse, and a mandatory re-simulation gate catching stock shortages before any write. Surfaced three unresolved architectural questions as annotations for the developer rather than deciding them silently.
- Delivered a click-through prototype of six named walkthroughs with plain-language written handover, so the project manager and developer could run client sessions without me. Held design-system fidelity at over 3,000 real HubSpot component instances against two local copies, with every deviation annotated on canvas with its reason.
- Designed a second shipped HubSpot UI extension for Redslim, a CPQ quoting system that improved quoting speed and accuracy.

Client delivery and process

- Delivery lead on a \$52,000 UX and CRO rebuild programme for Apella Wealth, a US financial planning firm, resourced with a single project manager. Led web, UX and CRO discovery including site architecture, homepage wireframes, trust-signal placement and above-fold hierarchy.
- Built a twelve-month CRO roadmap for Dayshape, an AI-powered resource management platform used by professional services firms across 55 countries, covering full CRO audit, hypothesis design and phased implementation, presented directly to the client marketing lead. Contributed to the WordPress to HubSpot site rebuild, navigation and mega menu structure, demo request page optimisation and resources page UX.
- Led CRO analysis for Ruleguard, a UK RegTech platform, across the homepage, navigation header and FAQ pages, and specified a sitewide GTM event tracking schema.
- Delivered CRO research that shaped the Redslim rebrand, plus implementation and segmentation strategy and a post-launch monitoring framework.
- Contributed to the Employmate CRO programme, including a persona switch giving employers and job seekers separate content paths through a single site, journey friction removal, and rebuilt landing pages, CTAs and forms. Published as a case study by Evara, which credits me by name.
- Presented audits, hypothesis documents and multi-month roadmaps directly to CEOs and Heads of Marketing. That work converted into expanded retainers and increased scope on multiple accounts, including Dayshape moving to a larger package for faster delivery.
- Authored WCAG 2.1 AA contrast and alt-text standards applied in Figma at design stage and re-verified during post-deployment QA, catching accessibility regressions in design-to-development translation.
- Built and documented delivery processes, guidelines and AI-assisted ClickUp templates that standardised task setup and estimation and cut project set-up time. Adopted by squads beyond my own function.
- Ran monthly internal knowledge shares and presented at company conferences on CRO method, tooling and measurement.

UI/UX Designer and Front-End Developer, SearchKings Africa, Johannesburg

September 2022 - June 2025 | Hybrid

Design and front-end at a Google Ads and online lead generation agency, building the landing pages that paid traffic converted on. This is where conversion work started for me.

- Designed and built responsive landing pages, sales pages and lead capture forms in WordPress and Elementor using HTML and CSS, implementing UTM tracking so campaign performance could be attributed rather than estimated.
- Led website and interface redesigns across client accounts, introducing user flows and information architecture into a team process that had previously worked straight from visual comps.
- Developed and scaled design systems and modular UI component libraries, improving visual consistency and cutting design turnaround across repeat client work.
- Produced performance creative at volume alongside interface work: static and animated banner sets, newsletters, campaign assets and login interfaces, all built to a conversion brief rather than a brand one.
- Integrated and tested API solutions for e-commerce and lead-generation forms, improving conversion paths.
- Ran usability research and A/B testing, using analytics insight to refine interfaces.
- Managed site performance and security across client sites, including plugin updates, backups and technical enhancements.

Graphic & Clothing Designer Anatomic Sportswear

June 2022 - September 2022 | Permanent

- Designed custom and branded cycling apparel using CorelDRAW and Adobe Illustrator, developing initial concepts into production-ready artwork.
- Prepared garment layouts, colour-ways, branding placements and vector graphics for production.
- Refined artwork against garment templates and specifications to maintain accurate scale, proportion and visual consistency.

Co-Founder, Design and Marketing Lead, Apollo V Academy, Johannesburg

August 2020 - September 2022 | Self-employed, run alongside full-time employment until March 2021

Co-founded a two-partner design venture spanning apparel and vinyl, digital design services and a design academy. Employed one administrator and engaged one contractor. Traded 25 months selling packages that combined branding with digital services. Ceased trading 2022.

- Built and ran the company website end to end, including e-commerce and lead capture. Full ownership of the acquisition and conversion path with personal capital at risk, which is where my interest in conversion started.
- Delivered digital design across web, email, newsletters, social and video alongside apparel, vinyl and signage work.
- Built brand guidelines, visual identity and reusable design templates, improving consistency and production speed.
- Handled client briefs end to end, from specification through to production-ready artwork, and ran marketing campaigns across print, digital and social.

Finance Administrator, Arcfyre International

April 2018 - July 2020 | Concurrent: Training Administrator, Altor International, July 2020 - March 2021

Accounting and financial administration, and administration for a private security training academy. The commercial and numerical grounding from this period still shapes how I frame conversion work in revenue terms for financial-services clients.

PUBLISHED WORK

Work published publicly by my employer. Rare for a design portfolio and independently verifiable.

- Evara CPQ platform. Article plus an embedded video of me presenting the platform, its purpose and what was designed: evara.co/blog/why-we-built-our-own-cpq-and-what-it-means-for-scaling-modern-fintech-services
 - Employmate CRO case study, which credits me by name: evara.co/case-studies/employmate-cro
 - Dayshape case study: evara.co/case-studies/dayshape
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EDUCATION

BCom International Business: MANCOSA (Management College of South Africa), completed 2023

Project Management Programme: PM.Ideas, completed 2024. CAPM certification exam pending

Additional project experience

Siphiwo Sizonqoba Manana

UX UI Consultant, Evara | June 2025 - September 2026

Redslim website research and CRO strategy

Behavioural research for a retail and consumer-data harmonisation business. Developed segmentation and a prioritised CRO roadmap that informed a website redesign delivered by another agency.

- Built on existing marketing personas to develop five behavioural segments: research-oriented visitors, solution seekers, enterprise buyers, returning visitors, and referral or partner visitors. Connected their needs to journey and content recommendations.
- Reviewed 54 Microsoft Clarity session recordings, comprising 30 returning-user and 24 new-user sessions, alongside five GA4 path explorations and two macro funnels. Synthesised observed friction and journey patterns into actionable design recommendations.
- Developed 23 prioritised CRO hypotheses and a three-stage implementation and segmentation plan covering 20 workstreams. Recommendations addressed CTA visibility, trust, form interactions, solution and case-study templates, mobile journeys and navigation.
- Connected proposed changes to measurement requirements and a post-launch monitoring framework, giving the redesign team a structured basis for prioritisation and future validation.

Ownership: Research, behavioural segmentation, synthesis, hypotheses and roadmap. The marketing personas already existed. The client appointed another agency to execute the website redesign. These deliverables are not presented as completed experiments or a measured conversion uplift.

Portfolio: sizomanana.github.io/work/redslim-research.html

Separate engagement retained in the main experience

Redslim CPQ product design: The shipped HubSpot quotation tool is a separate project from this website research. Its product-design experience remains in the original CV. The portfolio case study covers mapping 50 pricing rules into a three-step configuration flow, visible overrides and searchable pricing guidance.

CPQ case study: sizomanana.github.io/work/cpq.html

Additional confirmed Figma capability

Confident daily use of Figma Auto Layout across designs to maintain flexible, consistent layout structures as content and components change.